SSC CHSL 2021 Tier-I question paper with answers

10 June 2022 · Shift 1

83 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 17 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20220816140307/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2021_16082022.pdf

English Language 23 questions

Q.1

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Affront

(A) Depress
(B) Fail
(C) Insult
(D) Tolerate

Q.2

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Particular
(B) Queu
(C) Recommend
(D) Opposition

Q.3

Spot the error in the given sentence and select the correct sentence from the options given. As soon as we went for an afternoon siesta, my pet rabbit Tia digged a huge hole right in the middle of the lawn.

(A) As soon as we were going for an afternoon siesta, my pet rabbit Tia digged a huge hole right in the middle of the lawn.
(B) As soon as we went for an afternoon siesta, my pet rabbit Tia dug a huge hole right in the middle of the lawn.
(C) As soon as we gone for an afternoon siesta, my pet rabbit Tia digged a huge hole right in the middle of the lawn.
(D) As soon as we gone for an afternoon siesta, my pet rabbit Tia dug a huge hole right in the middle of the lawn.

Q.4

Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice. My pocket has been picked.

(A) Someone’s pocket has been picked by me.
(B) Someone had my pocket picked.
(C) Someone has picked my pocket.
(D) I picked someone’s pocket.

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. She should run “the fast” to win the race.

(A) the fastest
(B) more fast
(C) a fastest
(D) the faster

Q.6

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Ravenous

(A) Commodious
(B) Iniquitous
(C) Scrumptious
(D) Esurient

Q.7

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Strain every nerve

(A) To have ill health
(B) To feel physical pain
(C) To try extremely hard to do something
(D) To fight with friends

Q.8

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I never could quite get the idea _____ my mind that I should do some teaching, yet I felt a great deal of satisfaction with the pastorate.

(A) out of
(B) out act
(C) out come
(D) out cast

Q.9

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence. After wearing the complete sports gear, he looked “lean, tough, and sinewy”.

(A) a toughie
(B) wirey
(C) wiry
(D) dewy

Q.10

Identify the option that arranges the given parts in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph. a) PB Shelly was an English poet. b) He was expelled from Oxford for publishing a tract entitled ‘The Necessity of Atheism’. c) He detested tyranny and institutionalised servitude. d) Born into a wealthy upper-class family.

(A) d,c,a,b
(B) a,d,c,b
(C) a,b,c,d
(D) c,a,b,d

Q.11

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. The movie I watched last Saturday was “much better interesting” than the one I watched today.

(A) much more interesting
(B) much interesting
(C) much lesser interesting
(D) much good interesting

Q.14

Select the correctly spelt word to fill in the blank. I really admire his _____ to fulfil his dream to join navy.

(A) persistance
(B) parsistance
(C) persistence
(D) parcistanse

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Looking or sounding foreign, bizarre, strange, unfamiliar

(A) Outlaw
(B) Outlay
(C) Outlast
(D) Outlandish

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No substitution required’. She “has returned” from Delhi a month ago.

(A) No substitution required
(B) would returned
(C) returned
(D) was returned

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Tedious

(A) Slack
(B) Abstract
(C) Gallant
(D) Exciting

Q.18

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Jump the gun

(A) To waste your money
(B) To do something stupid
(C) To defeat an opponent
(D) To do something too soon

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Siege

(A) Deference
(B) Trance
(C) Clearance
(D) Inference

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the word given in the brackets to fill in the blank. When the lady answered the knock at her door she found a _____ (destitute) man.

(A) replete
(B) polite
(C) indigent
(D) greedy

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. First of all, planting trees should be given (1) _____ attention. Above all, tree is the (2) _____ of oxygen. Unfortunately, due to (3) _____ of buildings many trees have been cut down. This (4) _____ reduces the amount of oxygen in the environment. Growing (5) _____ trees means (5) _____ oxygen. Hence, growing more trees would mean better life quality.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) lesser
(B) massive
(C) trivial
(D) minor

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. First of all, planting trees should be given (1) _____ attention. Above all, tree is the (2) _____ of oxygen. Unfortunately, due to (3) _____ of buildings many trees have been cut down. This (4) _____ reduces the amount of oxygen in the environment. Growing (5) _____ trees means (5) _____ oxygen. Hence, growing more trees would mean better life quality.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) source
(B) base
(C) foundation
(D) tank

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. First of all, planting trees should be given (1) _____ attention. Above all, tree is the (2) _____ of oxygen. Unfortunately, due to (3) _____ of buildings many trees have been cut down. This (4) _____ reduces the amount of oxygen in the environment. Growing (5) _____ trees means (5) _____ oxygen. Hence, growing more trees would mean better life quality.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3

(A) planning
(B) destruction
(C) construction
(D) renovation

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. First of all, planting trees should be given (1) _____ attention. Above all, tree is the (2) _____ of oxygen. Unfortunately, due to (3) _____ of buildings many trees have been cut down. This (4) _____ reduces the amount of oxygen in the environment. Growing (5) _____ trees means (5) _____ oxygen. Hence, growing more trees would mean better life quality.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) certainly
(B) doubtfully
(C) rarely
(D) hardly

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. First of all, planting trees should be given (1) _____ attention. Above all, tree is the (2) _____ of oxygen. Unfortunately, due to (3) _____ of buildings many trees have been cut down. This (4) _____ reduces the amount of oxygen in the environment. Growing (5) _____ trees means (5) _____ oxygen. Hence, growing more trees would mean better life quality.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) no, more
(B) more, more
(C) less, more
(D) more, less

General Intelligence 19 questions

Q.2

Which of the following letter-clusters will replace the question mark (?) in the given series to make it logically complete? AYC, EUG, IQK, MMO, ?

(A) IQS
(B) QIS
(C) SIQ
(D) ISQ

Q.3

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Perilous 2.Pessimist 3.Pedestrian 4.Perceive 5.Perfect 6.Peasant

(A) 6, 4, 3, 1, 2, 5
(B) 6, 3, 4, 5, 1, 2
(C) 3, 6, 5, 4, 2, 1
(D) 3, 5, 4, 6, 1, 2

Q.4

Select the option that represents the letters that, when placed from left to right in the blanks, will complete the letter series. M _ W Q U N S _ Q U O S W _ U P S _ Q _

(A) S Q U W W
(B) S Q W U W
(C) S W Q W U
(D) S W Q U W

Q.5

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs except one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 678:7
(B) 282:6
(C) 366:5
(D) 546:5

Q.7

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation.
42*19*4*69*81*9*58

(A) +, ×,−,+,÷,=
(B) ÷,−,×,=,×,+
(C) −,−,=,×,÷,−
(D) ×,−,=,+,×,−

Q.8

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to replace the * signs and to balance the given equation.
40*2*15*30*5

(A) ×,−,=,+
(B) ×,=,−,−
(C) ÷,=,+,−
(D) ÷,+,=,+

Q.9

The second number in the given number pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) are followed in all the number pairs, EXCEPT one. Find that odd number pair.

(A) 40 : 240
(B) 25 : 150
(C) 35 : 280
(D) 30 : 180

Q.10

Select the option that is related to the third term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the sixth term is related to the fifth term. 27 : 99 :: 21 : ? :: 13 : 43

(A) 75
(B) 64
(C) 87
(D) 82

Q.11

The second number in the given number-pairs is obtained by performing certain mathematical operation(s) on the first number. The same operation(s) is/are followed in all the number-pairs, except one. Find that odd number-pair.

(A) 12:121
(B) 6:25
(C) 9:100
(D) 8:49

Q.12

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row:5, 9, 56; Second row: 4, 7, 33; Third row:10, 11, ? (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the number into its constituent digits. For example, 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding/deleting/multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed.)

(A) 30
(B) 26
(C) 23
(D) 21

Q.14

In a certain code language, 'MAP' is written as 'QBN' and 'LEAP' is written as 'QBFM'. How will 'CROWN' be written in that language?

(A) OXPDS
(B) OXPSD
(C) OPDXS
(D) ODXSP

Q.15

Three statements are given, followed by three conclusions numbered I, II and III. Assuming the statements to be true, even if they seem to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Some boxes are houses. Some houses are tents. Some tents are castles. Conclusions: I. Some castles are houses. II. Some tents are houses. III. Some castles are boxes.

(A) Only conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Only conclusions I and III follow

Q.16

Seven friends P, Q, R, S, T, U and V, each has a different height. P is taller than only U and R. R is taller than U. Q is taller than S but shorter than T. T is not the tallest among all. The height of how many people is between the heights of Q and R?

(A) 3
(B) 1
(C) 2
(D) 0

Q.17

Study the given pattern carefully and select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in it. First row- 5, 16, 77; Second row- 13, 12, ?; Third row- 8, 19, 149 (NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is NOT allowed)

(A) 157
(B) 153
(C) 151
(D) 155

Q.18

Select the option that is related to the fourth term in the same way as the first term is related to the second term and the fifth term is related to the sixth term. 6 : 40 :: ? : 148 :: 3 : 13.

(A) 13
(B) 12
(C) 17
(D) 14

Q.20

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. GAINS : SNIAG :: ANVIL : LIVNA :: INBOX : ?

(A) XOBNI
(B) BINOX
(C) ONBIX
(D) OXBIN

Q.22

Which of the following numbers will replace the question mark (?) in the given series? 283, 359, 428, 490, 545, ?

(A) 593
(B) 613
(C) 600
(D) 563

Q.23

Select the option that represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in an English dictionary. 1.Dictation 2.Dictator 3.Distribute 4.Decadent 5.Distilled

(A) 4,3,1,2,5
(B) 4,2,1,3,5
(C) 4,1,2,3,5
(D) 4,1,2,5,3

Q.25

In a certain code language, “EASY” is written as “YAES”, and “KIND” is written as “DIKN”. How will “SOME” be written in that language?

(A) ESOM
(B) EOSM
(C) EOMS
(D) OESM

Quantitative Aptitude 16 questions

Q.4

For the first part of her journey, Sunita travelled at a speed of 450 m/min and, for the rest of the journey, at a speed 1.4 times of her initial speed. If Sunita travelled a total distance of 33.3 km in 1hour, what was the distance that Sunita travelled at a lower speed?

(A) 11.50 km
(B) 11.15 km
(C) 11.25 km
(D) 11.20 km

Q.5

40 men can complete a piece of work in 18 days. 9 days after they start working together, 5 more men join them. How many days will they now take to complete the remaining work?

(A) 9 days
(B) 8 days
(C) 6 days
(D) 7 days

Q.6

A sum of money is invested at a rate of compounded interest that is paid out yearly. In the first two years, the interest was ₹400 and ₹420 respectively. The sum is:

(A) ₹7,500
(B) ₹9,530
(C) ₹8,000
(D) ₹8,765

Q.7

A man spends 20% of his monthly salary on food and one-fourth of the remaining salary on charity. If he saves ₹9,600 per month, which is equal to half of the balance after spending on food and charity, then his monthly salary is:

(A) ₹28,000
(B) ₹32,000
(C) ₹26,000
(D) ₹30,000

Q.8

What is the length of the arc of a circle whose radius is 35 cm and arc subtends an angle of 36° at the centre of the circle? (Take π=22/7)

(A) 44 cm
(B) 22 cm
(C) 10 cm
(D) 220 cm

Q.12

Find the value of ‘a’ using the concept of BODMAS. $42 \div 2 + a \times 3 - 22 = 8$

(A) 4
(B) 6
(C) 5
(D) 3

Q.13

In an examination, the Average marks of 7 children was 20, that of 3 children was 45, that of another 4 children was 15 and that of 2 children was 0. What is the average marks of all the 16 children? (Correct to one decimal place)

(A) 20
(B) 20.9
(C) 4
(D) 4.9

Q.14

A washing machine is sold at a discount of 10% on its marked price. A further discount of 5% on the initial selling price is offered if a person makes the payment in cash. If the marked price of the machine is ₹54,000, how much will a customer paying in cash have to pay for purchasing it?

(A) ₹46,200
(B) ₹45,800
(C) ₹46,170
(D) ₹46,000

Q.15

The length, breadth and height of a room are 7 m, 4 m and 9 m, respectively. Find the cost of whitewashing the walls of the room and the ceiling at the rate of ₹7.50 per m^2.

(A) ₹1,965
(B) ₹1,695
(C) ₹1,968
(D) ₹1,698

Q.16

Find the selling price of an article if a shopkeeper allows two successive discounts of 5% each on the marked price of ₹80.

(A) ₹76.60
(B) ₹72
(C) ₹72.20
(D) ₹74.40

Q.17

Which of the following numbers is NOT divisible by 15?

(A) 2595
(B) 3195
(C) 3465
(D) 2995

Q.21

If the length, breadth and height of a cuboid are 7.5 m, 22 m and 13 m, respectively, then find the volume of the cuboid.

(A) 2145 m^3
(B) 1245 m^3
(C) 4215 m^3
(D) 2154 m^3

Q.22

What is the average of first 10 multiples of 6?

(A) 55
(B) 66
(C) 60
(D) 33

Q.23

The price of a bike is ₹75,500. What will be the price of the bike after a reduction of 17%?

(A) ₹68,650
(B) ₹68,680
(C) ₹62,665
(D) ₹62,650

Q.24

If the compound interest on a principal for one year is ₹350 and the compound interest for the second year is ₹420, find the rate of interest.

(A) 30%
(B) 20%
(C) 25%
(D) 15%

Q.25

The area of quadrilateral is 336 m^2 and the perpendiculars drawn to one diagonal from the opposite vertices are 16 m and 12 m long. Find the length of this diagonal.

(A) 28 cm
(B) 26 cm
(C) 21 cm
(D) 24 cm

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

In which of the following years was Lata Mangeshkar, a legendry playback Indian singer, awarded with the Padma Vibhushan, the second-highest Indian civilian award?

(A) 1990
(B) 1995
(C) 1999
(D) 2003

Q.2

In February 2021, _____ broke into the Top-100 WTA doubles rankings, becoming the second woman, after Sania Mirza, to do so.

(A) Shikha Devi Uberoi
(B) Ankita Raina
(C) Tara Iyer
(D) Rushmi Chakravarthi

Q.3

Who among the following won the prestigious Abhinandan Saroja National Award 2021?

(A) Saroja Vaidyanathan
(B) Aparna Satheesan
(C) Mrinalini Sarabhai
(D) Alarmel Valli

Q.4

Identify a way that does NOT prevent a non-communicable disease from occurring in someone.

(A) Blood transfusion
(B) Adequate sleep
(C) Balanced diet
(D) Healthy diet

Q.5

Identify the group of the periodic table to which iron belongs.

(A) Group 8
(B) Group 6
(C) Group 5
(D) Group 7

Q.6

Who among the following is the author of the book ‘Five Point Someone’?

(A) Durjoy Dutta
(B) Chetan Bhagat
(C) Ravinder Singh
(D) Amish Tripathy

Q.7

For what discovery was Jan Evangelista Purkinje known in 1839?

(A) Proposed a lipid bilayer membrane
(B) Discovered plasma membrane
(C) Coined the term protoplasm
(D) Discovered the nucleus

Q.8

In which year was the Indian Football Association established?

(A) 1853
(B) 1873
(C) 1883
(D) 1893

Q.9

The Konark Dance Festival is held at an open air auditorium in the backdrop of the _____ which is also known as the Black Pagoda.

(A) Shree Somnath Temple
(B) Sun Temple
(C) Guruvayur Temple
(D) Kamakhya Temple

Q.10
Among the following, whose autobiography is ‘My Confession’?

(A) Adolf Hitler
(B) Leo Tolstoy
(C) Nelson Mandela
(D) Mahatma Gandhi

Q.11
‘Drawing From the City’ is a visual autobiography of which of the following Indian folk artists?

(A) Teju Behun
(B) Jamini Roy
(C) Bhajju Shyam
(D) Baua Devi

Q.12
‘All minorities, whether based on religion or language, shall have the right to establish and administer educational institutions of their choice’. Which article of the Constitution of India guarantees this right?

(A) Article 25
(B) Article 28
(C) Article 36
(D) Article 30

Q.13
What is the common name of C_6H_6?

(A) Methanol
(B) Acetic acid
(C) Acetone
(D) Benzene

Q.14
Phytoplankton, small sea-dwelling organisms, belong to which trophic level of the food web?

(A) Primary consumers
(B) Secondary consumers
(C) Primary producers
(D) Decomposers

Q.15
Which of the following serves as the cell's digestive system, serving both to degrade material taken from outside the cell and to digest the undigested components of the cell?

(A) Ribosomes
(B) Lysosomes
(C) Smooth endoplasmic reticulum
(D) Cytosol

Q.16
What is India’s rank in the 2021 Global Hunger Index?

(A) 95
(B) 90
(C) 101
(D) 99

Q.17
Pandit Swapan Chaudhuri is associated with _____ instrument.

(A) veena
(B) harmonium
(C) tabla
(D) bansuri

Q.18
Who among the following became the first Indian male shuttler to win silver in the men's singles event at the BWF World Championships on December 19, 2021?

(A) HS Prannoy
(B) B Sai Praneeth
(C) Lakshya Sen
(D) Kidambi Srikanth

Q.19

Who among the following founded the 'Kalakshetra' in 1936, an Indian arts academy that was especially dedicated to the cultivation of the Bharatanatyam tradition?

(A) Rukmini Devi Arundale
(B) Vidyagauri Adkar
(C) Kumari kamala
(D) Damayanti Joshi

Q.20

Pankaj Advani is related to which of the following sports?

(A) Squash
(B) Billiards
(C) Tennis
(D) Chess

Q.21

Which of the following is true?

(A) Gross Domestic Product + Depreciation = Gross National Product
(B) Gross Domestic Product + Depreciation = Net Domestic Product
(C) Gross Domestic Product – Depreciation = Gross National Product
(D) Gross Domestic Product – Depreciation = Net Domestic Product

Q.22

Who among the following is the founder of the Indore Gharana of music?

(A) Ustad Amir Khan
(B) MS Subbulakshmi
(C) Vilayat Khan
(D) Bhimsen Joshi

Q.23

Anup Jalota is famous for which of the following categories of Indian music?

(A) Bhajan
(B) Carnatic Music
(C) Hindustani Music
(D) Instrumental

Q.24

Mallika Sarabhai is the most famous Indian dancer renowned for ____.

(A) kuchipudi and bharatanatyam
(B) bharatanatyam and kathak
(C) bharatanatyam and odissi
(D) kuchipudi and kathak

Q.25

As per Census of India 2011, which state has the highest percentage of Scheduled Tribe population to total Scheduled Tribe population in India?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Jharkhand
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Chhattisgarh

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**
Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**
Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(B)**	

General Intelligence

Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**
Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(C)**
Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**	Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**
Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**	Q.25 **(D)**		

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(A)**	Q.24 **(A)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (C) Insult

An 'affront' is an action or remark that causes offence: an 'insult'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Queu

The correct spelling is 'queue'.

Q.3 · Answer (B) As soon as we went for an afternoon siesta, my pet rabbit Tia dug a huge hole right in the middle of the lawn.

The past tense of 'dig' is 'dug', not 'digged'; 'went' is right for the completed action.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Someone has picked my pocket.

The present perfect passive 'has been picked' becomes the active 'has picked', with the unnamed agent supplied as 'someone': 'Someone has picked my pocket.'

Q.5 · Answer (A) the fastest

To win the race she must be faster than all the others: the superlative, 'the fastest'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Esurient

'Ravenous' means extremely hungry; 'esurient' means hungry or greedy.

Q.7 · Answer (C) To try extremely hard to do something

To 'strain every nerve' is to make every possible effort.

Q.8 · Answer (A) out of

To 'get an idea out of one's mind' is to stop thinking of it: 'get the idea out of my mind'.

Q.9 · Answer (C) wiry

'Wiry' describes someone lean, tough and sinewy; 'wirey' is a misspelling.

Q.10 · Answer (B) a,d,c,b

a introduces the poet and d, a fragment, continues it with his birth; c gives his convictions and b the tract that got him expelled: a, d, c, b.

Q.11 · Answer (A) much more interesting

'Interesting' forms its comparative with 'more', which 'much' can strengthen: 'much more interesting'.

Q.14 · Answer (C) persistence

The correct spelling is 'persistence'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Outlandish

'Outlandish' means looking or sounding bizarre or unfamiliar.

Q.16 · Answer (C) returned

'A month ago' marks a finished past time, which takes the simple past, not the present perfect: 'She returned from Delhi a month ago.'

Q.17 · Answer (D) Exciting

'Tedious' means long and dull; its opposite is 'exciting'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) To do something too soon

To 'jump the gun' is to act too soon, like a runner who starts before the starting gun.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Clearance

SSC's key gives 'clearance'. A siege surrounds a place and cuts it off; 'clearance', the removal of an obstruction, is the nearest to an opposite among the options, and 'deference', 'trance' and 'inference' are unrelated.

Q.20 · Answer (C) indigent
'Destitute' means without money or the necessities of life: 'indigent'.

Q.21 · Answer (B) massive
Planting trees deserves 'massive' attention; 'lesser', 'trivial' and 'minor' contradict the passage's point.

Q.22 · Answer (A) source
Trees release oxygen: they are its 'source'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) construction
Trees are cut down to make way for the 'construction' of buildings.

Q.24 · Answer (A) certainly
Cutting down trees 'certainly' reduces the oxygen in the environment.

Q.25 · Answer (B) more, more
'Growing more trees means more oxygen', as the next sentence, 'growing more trees would mean better life quality', confirms.

General Intelligence

Q.2 · Answer (B) QIS
First letters move +4 (A, E, I, M, Q), second letters –4 (Y, U, Q, M, I) and third letters +4 (C, G, K, O, S): QIS.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 6, 3, 4, 5, 1, 2
In dictionary order: Peasant (6), Pedestrian (3), Perceive (4), Perfect (5), Perilous (1), Pessimist (2).

Q.4 · Answer (C) S W Q W U
With S, W, Q, W, U in the blanks the series reads MSWQU NSWQU OSWQU PSWQU: the first letter moves on one each time and SWQU repeats.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 282:6
In 678 : 7, 366 : 5 and 546 : 5 the second number is the average of the first number's digits (21 ÷ 3, 15 ÷ 3, 15 ÷ 3). For 282 it would be 12 ÷ 3 = 4, not 6.

Q.7 · Answer (A) +, ×,–,+,÷,=
42 + 19 × 4 – 69 + 81 ÷ 9 = 42 + 76 – 69 + 9 = 58.

Q.8 · Answer (D) ÷,+,=,+
40 ÷ 2 + 15 = 20 + 15 = 35, and 30 + 5 = 35.

Q.9 · Answer (C) 35 : 280
In the other pairs the second number is 6 times the first (40 × 6 = 240, 25 × 6 = 150, 30 × 6 = 180); 35 × 6 = 210, not 280.

Q.10 · Answer (A) 75
The second number is 4 times the first minus 9: 27 × 4 – 9 = 99 and 13 × 4 – 9 = 43. Likewise 21 × 4 – 9 = 75.

Q.11 · Answer (C) 9:100
The second number is the square of one less than the first: $11^2 = 121$, $5^2 = 25$ and $7^2 = 49$. But 9 gives $8^2 = 64$, not 100.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 21
In each row the third number is the difference of the squares of the first two: $9^2 – 5^2 = 81 – 25 = 56$ and $7^2 – 4^2 = 49 – 16 = 33$. So $11^2 – 10^2 = 121 – 100 = 21$.

Q.14 · Answer (B) OXPSD
The word is reversed and each letter moved one place forward: MAP → PAM → QBN and LEAP → PAEL → QBFM. So CROWN → NWORC → OXPSD.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Only conclusion II follows
Some houses are tents, so some tents are houses (II). The 'some' links give no definite overlap between castles and houses or between castles and boxes, so I and III do not follow.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 2
P is taller than only U and R, and R is taller than U: from the shortest, U, R, P. Of the rest S < Q < T, and T is not the tallest, so V is: U, R, P, S, Q, T, V. P and S stand between R and Q: two people.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 153
In each row the third number is the product of the first two minus 3: 5 × 16 − 3 = 77 and 8 × 19 − 3 = 149. So 13 × 12 − 3 = 153.

Q.18 · Answer (B) 12
The second number is the square of the first plus 4: $6^2 + 4 = 40$ and $3^2 + 4 = 13$. 148 − 4 = 144 = 12^2.

Q.20 · Answer (A) XOBNI
Each word is written in reverse: GAINS → SNIAG and ANVIL → LIVNA. So INBOX → XOBNI.

Q.22 · Answer (A) 593
The differences are 76, 69, 62, 55, falling by 7 each time, so the next is 48: 545 + 48 = 593.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 4,1,2,5,3
In dictionary order: Decadent (4), Dictation (1), Dictator (2), Distilled (5), Distribute (3); 'Dictati-' comes before 'Dictato-' and 'Distil-' before 'Distri-'.

Q.25 · Answer (B) EOSM
The letters are rearranged 4th, 2nd, 1st, 3rd: E A S Y → Y A E S and K I N D → D I K N. So S O M E → E O S M.

Quantitative Aptitude

Q.4 · Answer (C) 11.25 km
At 450 m/min for t minutes and 1.4 × 450 = 630 m/min for the rest: 450t + 630(60 − t) = 33,300, so 180t = 4,500 and t = 25. The slower part was 450 × 25 = 11,250 m = 11.25 km.

Q.5 · Answer (B) 8 days
The work is 40 × 18 = 720 man-days; 40 × 9 = 360 are done, and the 45 men finish the other 360 in 360 ÷ 45 = 8 days.

Q.6 · Answer (C) ₹8,000
The second year's interest exceeds the first's by ₹20, the interest on ₹400 for a year, so the rate is 20/400 = 5%. Sum = 400 ÷ 0.05 = ₹8,000.

Q.7 · Answer (B) ₹32,000
After food 80% is left; charity takes a quarter of it (20% of the salary), leaving 60%. Half of that, 30% of the salary, is ₹9,600, so the salary is ₹32,000.

Q.8 · Answer (B) 22 cm
Arc = (36/360) × 2 × (22/7) × 35 = (1/10) × 220 = 22 cm.

Q.12 · Answer (D) 3
Division and multiplication first: 21 + 3a − 22 = 8, so 3a = 9 and a = 3.

Q.13 · Answer (B) 20.9
Total marks = 7 × 20 + 3 × 45 + 4 × 15 + 2 × 0 = 140 + 135 + 60 = 335, and 335 ÷ 16 = 20.9375, which is 20.9 to one decimal place.

Q.14 · Answer (C) ₹46,170
₹54,000 × 0.9 = ₹48,600, and 5% off that for cash: ₹48,600 × 0.95 = ₹46,170.

Q.15 · Answer (B) ₹1,695
Four walls = 2(7 + 4) × 9 = 198 m² and the ceiling 7 × 4 = 28 m²: 226 m² × ₹7.50 = ₹1,695.

Q.16 · Answer (C) ₹72.20
₹80 × 0.95 × 0.95 = ₹72.20.

Q.17 · Answer (D) 2995
A number divisible by 15 must be divisible by 3 and by 5. All four end in 5, but the digits of 2995 add up to 25, which is not divisible by 3.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 2145 m³
Volume = 7.5 × 22 × 13 = 165 × 13 = 2,145 m³.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 33
The first 10 multiples of 6 are 6, 12, …, 60; their average is (6 + 60)/2 = 33.

Q.23 · Answer (C) ₹62,665
₹75,500 × 0.83 = ₹62,665.

Q.24 · Answer (B) 20%
The second year's interest exceeds the first's by ₹70, the interest on ₹350 for a year: 70/350 = 20%.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 24 cm
Area = ½ × diagonal × (16 + 12) = 14 × diagonal = 336 m², so the diagonal is 24 m. SSC's key gives '24 cm': all four options print the unit as cm, a misprint, since the question's lengths are in metres.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) 1999
Lata Mangeshkar received the Padma Vibhushan in 1999; she had received the Padma Bhushan in 1969 and went on to receive the Bharat Ratna in 2001.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Ankita Raina
Ankita Raina entered the top 100 of the WTA doubles rankings in February 2021, after winning her first WTA title, the Phillip Island Trophy doubles, with Kamilla Rakhimova.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Aparna Satheesan
The National Institute of Indian Classical Dance gave its Abhinandan Saroja National Award for 2021 to Aparna Satheesan, a US-based Bharatanatyam and Kuchipudi dancer, at a ceremony held online in November 2021.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Blood transfusion
Adequate sleep and a balanced, healthy diet lower the risk of non-communicable diseases such as diabetes and heart disease; a blood transfusion is a medical treatment, not a way of preventing them.

Q.5 · Answer (A) Group 8
Iron (Fe) is a transition metal in Group 8 of the modern periodic table, with ruthenium and osmium.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Chetan Bhagat
'Five Point Someone' (2004), set at IIT Delhi, was Chetan Bhagat's first novel.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Coined the term protoplasm
In 1839 Purkinje coined the term 'protoplasm' for the living substance of the cell.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 1893
The Indian Football Association was founded in Calcutta in 1893.

Q.9 · Answer (B) Sun Temple
The festival's open-air auditorium at Konark, Odisha, has the 13th-century Sun Temple as its backdrop; sailors called the temple the Black Pagoda.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Leo Tolstoy
Leo Tolstoy's 'A Confession', also translated as 'My Confession', recounts the spiritual crisis of his middle years.

Q.11 · Answer (A) Teju Behun
'Drawing from the City' (Tara Books, 2012) is the visual autobiography of the self-taught folk artist Teju Behan (Tejubehan), who began drawing after moving to Ahmedabad.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Article 30
Article 30(1) gives all minorities, religious or linguistic, the right to establish and administer educational institutions of their choice.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Benzene
C_6H_6 is benzene, an aromatic hydrocarbon. Methanol is CH_3OH, acetic acid CH_3COOH and acetone CH_3COCH_3.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Primary producers
Phytoplankton make their own food by photosynthesis, so they are the primary producers, the first trophic level, of aquatic food webs.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Lysosomes
Lysosomes hold digestive enzymes that break down material taken into the cell as well as the cell's own worn-out parts.

Q.16 · Answer (C) 101
India ranked 101st of 116 countries in the Global Hunger Index 2021.

Q.17 · Answer (C) tabla
Pandit Swapan Chaudhuri is a leading tabla player.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Kidambi Srikanth
Kidambi Srikanth lost the final of the 2021 BWF World Championships at Huelva, Spain, to Loh Kean Yew of Singapore, and became the first Indian man to win silver at the event.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Rukmini Devi Arundale
Rukmini Devi Arundale founded Kalakshetra in Madras (Chennai) in 1936.

Q.20 · Answer (B) Billiards
Pankaj Advani is a many-time world champion in English billiards and snooker.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Gross Domestic Product – Depreciation = Net Domestic Product
Net Domestic Product is GDP minus depreciation (consumption of fixed capital); GNP is GDP plus net factor income from abroad.

Q.22 · Answer (A) Ustad Amir Khan
Ustad Amir Khan founded the Indore gharana of Hindustani vocal music.

Q.23 · Answer (A) Bhajan
Anup Jalota, known as the 'Bhajan Samrat', is famous for his devotional bhajans.

Q.24 · Answer (A) kuchipudi and bharatanatyam
Mallika Sarabhai, daughter of the dancer Mrinalini Sarabhai, is known for Kuchipudi and Bharatanatyam.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Madhya Pradesh
By Census 2011, Madhya Pradesh has 14.7% of India's Scheduled Tribe population, the largest share, followed by Maharashtra (10.1%) and Odisha (9.2%).

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